RetailzPOS / Moolah Points — Daily Trending Topics Brief

October 15, 2026

Trending now — 3 topics with a genuine brand angle

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
1	**Spirit Halloween opened a record 1,575 stores this season**, backing up the $13.5B Halloween spending projection — and with Halloween 16 days out, the window to lock stocking and staffing plans is closing.	Haunted Attraction Network — Spirit Halloween Costumes for 2026	**Instagram/LinkedIn, countdown reminder.** “A record 1,575 Spirit Halloween stores opened this season — that’s how real this spend is. 16 days out: if the stocking and staffing plan isn’t locked yet, this is the week.” A natural moment to resurface the stocking/staffing and costume/ID-verification pieces already published this month, not write new ones from scratch.

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2	**Distillers are releasing Diwali-specific limited editions** — a UK single malt (Indri) just dropped a numbered Diwali Collector's Edition — a concrete signal that Diwali is becoming a real gifting-occasion spirits play, not a niche one.	Drinks Intel — This Week's New Spirits Launches, 5–9 October 2026	**Instagram/LinkedIn, builds on the Oct 13 Diwali heads-up.** "Distillers are already shipping Diwali-specific limited editions — proof this is turning into a real gifting occasion for spirits, not just a calendar note. With Diwali three weeks out (Nov 8), this is the window to have a few gift-ready bottles positioned if your store serves that customer base." Kept general since this specific release is UK-market — the signal is the point, not the exact bottle.
3	**Spiritless relaunched its brand around a non-alcoholic espresso martini** — another sign the NA shelf is moving toward specific, premium cocktail formats, not just "beer alternatives."	Brewbound — Press Releases, Oct. 6, 2026	**Instagram, light product-spotlight.** "Spiritless just relaunched around a non-alcoholic espresso martini — the NA shelf keeps getting more specific and more premium. Worth a look if that section hasn't been refreshed since summer." Neutral, no overconsumption framing — this is a non-alcoholic product note.

Skipped, no genuine angle today: another MLB postseason angle (NLCS/ALCS results unconfirmed in available sources, and this well has run dry for the month — holding for the World Series itself, Oct 23), and smoke-shop crime coverage (every lead found was undated or clearly from prior years, and the one dated story involved a worker's death — not something to adapt into content without solid, current sourcing).

Compliance check: none of the above imply pricing, encourage overconsumption, or use underage-adjacent framing — #1 points back to already-published compliance/staffing content, #2 is a gifting-occasion signal with no specific offer, #3 is a neutral NA-category note.